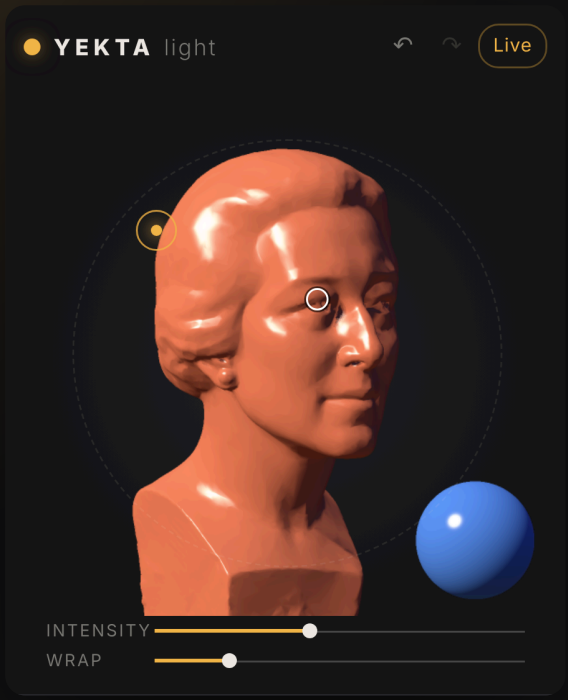
YEKTA light



USER GUIDE

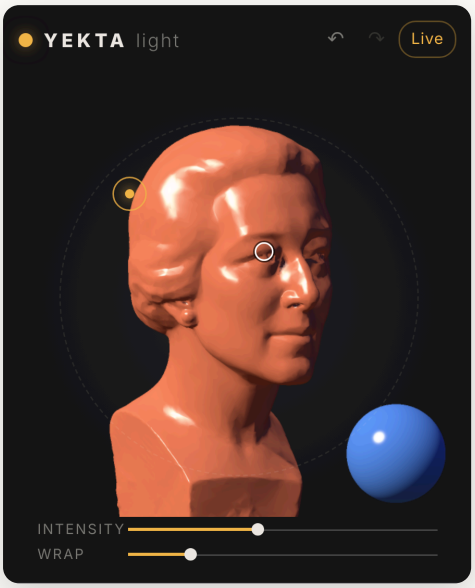
Every option, explained.

Light a 3D form, then pick the color the light really makes — highlight, halftone, core shadow, reflected light. This guide walks through every control of Yekta Light.

01 · THE IDEA

How Yekta Light works

Instead of guessing what a color does in light and shadow, you place a real light on a real 3D form and read the result. Every color you pick is physically lit.



The fixed top area

Layout

The panel has two parts. The **top** — logo, 3D view and two quick sliders — never scrolls, so you always see the result. Everything **below** scrolls: tools, palettes and settings. Change any option and watch the form update live.

A typical workflow

1. Choose a form (a head, the skull, a sphere...).
2. Light it — drag the sun or pick a portrait setup.
3. Check the shapes in **Notan** and the values in **3 / 5**.
4. Switch to **Color** and set your local color (Base).
5. Pick colors from the form or from the **Light Families**, and paint.

02 · HEADER

Top bar

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
↶ ↷ **Undo / Redo**	Steps back and forward through your changes to the look (light, materials, colors, camera). Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Shift+Z.
Live	On: the color is sent to Photoshop (or copied in the desktop app) continuously while you drag on the form. Off: only when you release.
Pin (desktop app)	Keeps the Yekta Light window on top of Clip Studio Paint.

03 · THE 3D VIEW

Picking and lighting



Color



Notan

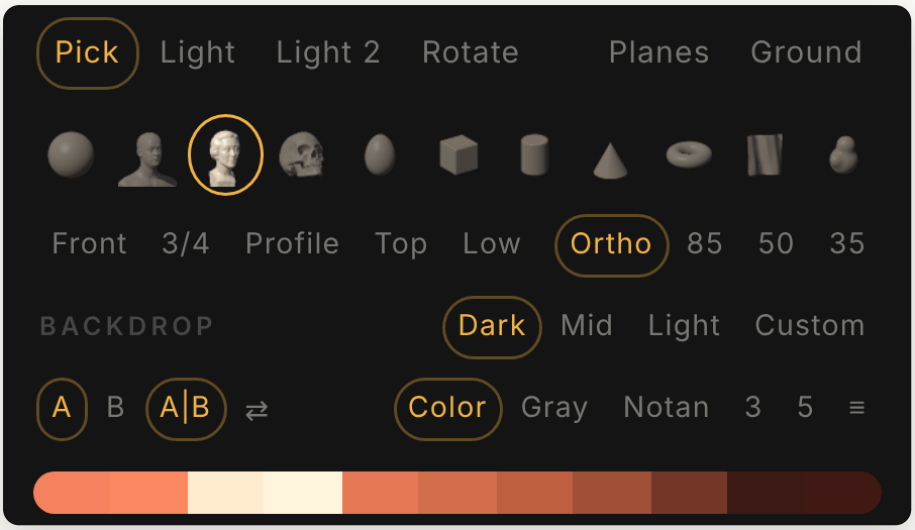


5 values

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Click / drag on the form	Picks the lit color under the cursor. A ring marks the spot.
Sun handle (amber)	The key light. Drag it anywhere. Inside the dashed ring the light is in front of the form; outside the ring it moves behind it (back light / rim).
Light 2 handle (blue)	The second light. Appears when Light 2 is on; drag it like the sun.
Alt + drag	Moves the key light without switching modes.
Shift + drag	Rotates the form without switching modes.
Small sphere (B)	Shows material B next to the main form for comparison (toggle A|B).
Intensity	Brightness of the key light. Double-click to reset.
Wrap	How far the light wraps around the form. Low = hard terminator (plaster, metal); high = soft, glowing transition (skin, fabric).

04 · TOOLS ROW

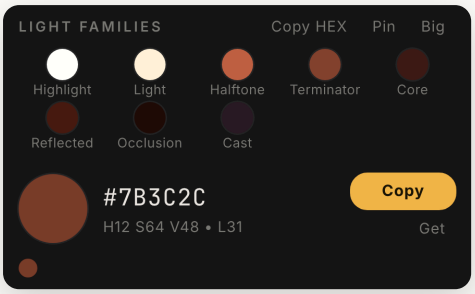
Modes, forms, camera, backdrop



CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Pick · Light · Light 2 · Rotate	What dragging on the 3D view does. Shortcuts: P, L, R.
Planes	Faceted block-in mode: the form is shown as flat planes, like a planes-of-the-head study.
Ground	Adds a ground plane with a cast shadow and contact shadow. You can pick the shadow color off the ground.
Forms	Sphere · male head scan · female head scan · skull · egg · cube · cylinder · cone · torus · drapery · organic form.
Front · 3/4 · Profile · Top · Low	Camera angles for the forms.
Ortho · 85 · 50 · 35	Lens. Ortho has no perspective; 35 mm gives strong perspective (close-up portrait look).
Backdrop	Background behind the form: Dark, Mid gray, Light or Custom (set its color in 03 Color ▸ Backdrop). Judge values against your canvas tone.
A · B · A|B · ⇄	Choose which material you edit (A = main form, B = small sphere), show/hide the B sphere, swap A and B.
Color · Gray · Notan · 3 · 5	Value modes. Gray = grayscale; Notan = two values (light / shadow); 3 and 5 = grouped values. Shortcut: V cycles them.
≡	Highlights every area that has the same value as the picked color — great for checking value groups.
Value ramp	The strip under the toolbar: every value across the form, from light to core shadow. Click to pick.

05 · LIGHT FAMILIES & PICK BAR

Named colors, ready to paint

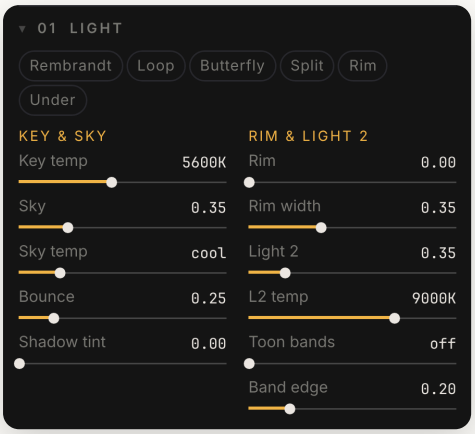


CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Highlight	The specular hot spot.
Light	Fully lit local color.
Halftone	Turning away from the light.
Terminator	Where light meets shadow — often the most saturated.
Core	Darkest part of the form shadow.
Rim	Edge light (appears when Rim is on).
Reflected	Bounce light inside the shadow.
Occlusion	Deepest contact darks.
Cast	Cast shadow color.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
+ Swatches / Copy HEX	Photoshop: adds all family colors to the Swatches panel. Desktop: copies them as a HEX list.
Pin	Pin mode: click a family color to lock it (amber dot) so it no longer changes with the light. Click again to unpin. Alt-click also pins.
Big	Large swatches — ideal for the Clip Studio screen eyedropper.
Big swatch + HEX	The picked color. Type a HEX code to set it directly.
H S V • L	Hue, saturation, value and perceived lightness (L) of the picked color.
Low chroma warning · Fix	Shown when a pick is much grayer than your base color (likely to read muddy). Fix restores color while keeping value and hue.
Set FG / Copy	Photoshop: sets the foreground color. Desktop: copies the HEX.
BG (Photoshop)	Sets the background color.
Get	Loads Photoshop's foreground (or a HEX from the clipboard) into the selected color target.
Follow FG (Photoshop)	When the Photoshop foreground changes, it becomes the base color of the form — preview any color under your light.
History dots	Your recent picks. Click to reuse.

06 · 01 LIGHT

Shape the light

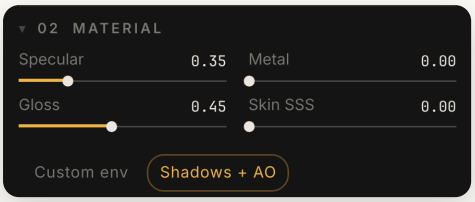


CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Rembrandt	Key 45° to the side and above — the classic triangle of light on the shadow cheek.
Loop	Softer side angle; small nose shadow loops toward the cheek.
Butterfly	Light from the front and above — symmetrical, glamour look.
Split	Light from the side — half the face in shadow.
Rim	Light from behind plus a soft front fill — glowing edges.
Under	Light from below — dramatic / horror.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Key temp	Color temperature of the key light in Kelvin: 2000 K candle-orange to 10000 K blue sky. 5600 K is daylight.
Sky	Strength of the ambient light from above (fills the shadows).
Sky temp	Cool to warm color of that ambient light.
Bounce	Light reflected up from the ground into the shadows (reflected light). Its color is set in 03 Color ▸ Bounce.
Shadow tint	Pushes the hue of the shadow areas toward a chosen color (03 Color ▸ Shadow) while keeping their value.
Rim · Rim width	Fresnel edge light and how wide it spreads.
Light 2	Strength of the second light (fill or kicker). Above 0 turns it on.
L2 temp	Kelvin temperature of the second light.
Toon bands · Band edge	Cel shading: splits the light into 2–6 flat bands; Band edge softens the transitions.

07 · 02 MATERIAL

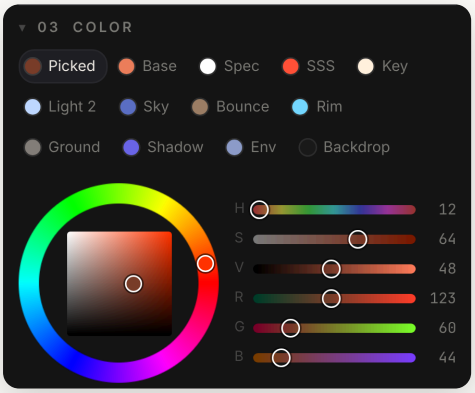
What the form is made of



CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Specular	Strength of the highlight.
Gloss	Size of the highlight: low = broad and soft (skin, clay), high = tiny and sharp (plastic, metal).
Metal	Metallic look: the highlight takes the base color and the environment is reflected.
Skin SSS	Subsurface scattering: a warm, saturated glow along the terminator, like light passing through skin. Its color is 03 Color ▸ SSS.
Custom env	Uses your own environment color (03 Color ▸ Env) for reflections on metal and gloss instead of the sky color.
Shadows + AO	Self-shadowing and ambient occlusion on the heads, skull, torus and drapery.

08 · 03 COLOR

Total color control

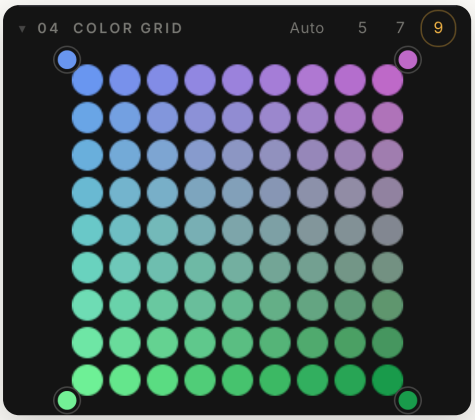


Choose a **target chip**, then edit it with the wheel (hue ring + saturation/value square) or the H S V R G B sliders. The form updates live.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Picked	The color you send to your app.
Base	Local color of the material.
Spec	Highlight color.
SSS	Subsurface glow color.
Key · Light 2	Light colors.
Sky · Bounce	Ambient light above / reflected light below.
Rim	Edge light color.
Ground	Ground plane color.
Shadow	Shadow tint color.
Env	Environment reflection color.
Backdrop	Custom background behind the form.

09 · 04 COLOR GRID

Harmonies between four colors



CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Corners	Click a corner dot to make it the color target, then edit it with the wheel.
Grid	Every step between the four corners, blended in OKLab (perceptually even). Click a dot to pick it.
Auto	Fills the corners from your current light families.
5 · 7 · 9	Grid density.

10 · 05 PRESETS

Looks in one click



Warm skin, Deep skin, Gold, Chrome, Glossy plastic, Matte clay, Plaster cast, Anime cel, Neon rim night, Sunset, Overcast, Campfire.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Click	Applies the light and the material.
Shift-click	Material only.
Alt-click	Light only.
+ Save	Saves your current light and material as a new preset (× deletes it).

11 · SHORTCUTS & PERFORMANCE

Good to know

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
P · L · R	Pick / Light / Rotate mode.
V	Cycle value modes.
Ctrl+Z · Ctrl+Shift+Z	Undo · Redo (Cmd on macOS).
Double-click a slider	Reset it to default.
Performance	Rendering runs in short slices, so Photoshop and Clip Studio stay responsive. While you drag you see a fast preview; the sharp frame follows when you stop. Nothing runs while you are not using the panel.

3D models: male head “Lee Perry-Smith” scan © Infinite-Realities, CC BY 3.0 · female head “Woman’s Head” by Artur Loewental, scan by Three D Scans · skull by Vladimir Petkovic, Khronos glTF samples, CC0. Yekta Light is free — yektapour.com